

Flash of the Titans

Point and shoot cameras aren't the best you can find. Every enthusiast dreams of owning a good DSLR, and now to add to the confusion, there are newer formats to choose from. It's time to demystify...



By Rossi Fernandes & Nimish Sawant

Almost every single one of us would like to own a DSLR sometime or the other. Sure, people tend to take you more seriously as a photographer, but that's not what it's all about! DSLRs are not meant to be cool gadgets

like a fancy watch or cellphone. A point-and-shoot makes perfect sense if you're the type who needs to take photos quickly at an event. But what if you're looking for perfection?

DSLRs have a lot going for them – with their bulk comes larger sensors, larger lenses, larger better quality screens and a whole load of controls and features that you can spend

days playing with. They're still meant for professionals but for those like us who love spending hours playing around with cameras and trying everything you can, point-and-shoots are not cutting it anymore. They're turning into tame.

We've called all the big DSLR names in India asking them to send across their cameras. Nikon, Canon and

Olympus were the ones who sent us many of their popular offerings. Sony politely declined from participating in the comparison review. Let's start by first looking at all of the features and usability aspect of the cameras.

Canon EOS 7D

Last year, we tested the EOS 50D. This year, we have the even better Canon EOS 7D. This larger bodied camera has a 18 MP sensor and fits perfectly in the hand. It is heavy though. The side of the camera has all the connects for the microphone, flash, remote control and HDMI. There are no direction buttons on the back of the camera, but there is a joystick. It's used to navigate through the menus. The dials on this new camera are pretty tight to rotate. Unlike most other cameras, the buttons used to set settings don't have to be held while using the jog dial. They like toggle buttons instead which makes them a little easier to use. Most of the controls surround the top display on the camera. The LCD screen doesn't have a border surround it which makes it almost seamless with the rest of the frame. The new menus look great, have smooth transition effects but there is no subdivision of the menus into categories or sections. One of the unique features on the camera is the virtual horizon feature which lets you to level the camera evenly.



Canon EOS 550D